

\$100 from your monthly expenses by being more efficient with grocery shopping, dining out less, switching phone plans, or cutting cable? A hundred bucks doesn't sound like a lot, but reframe the question: Is it worth it to work long enough to save \$30,000 more to go to a restaurant one night a month, have the most expensive phone plan, or keep cable TV? As a valuator, you have to answer that question. Understanding the impact of your spending on how quickly you can achieve FI may change that decision.

Is the Simple Path for You?

This is not an investing book, and this chapter is meant to serve only as an introduction to investing in stocks and bonds using index funds. The point is that the technical aspects of investing that intimidate so many and prevent them from getting started are overblown. You can be a successful investor with just one index fund that you buy and hold forever. Many investors fail to get started or pay far too much for unnecessary financial advice and products.

Simultaneously, others fail as investors because they underestimate the emotional and behavioral aspects of investing. While investing is simple, it is not easy. You need to go in with eyes wide open before committing money so you'll avoid acting on the